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The Bengal Situation

In dealing with the events between 1920 and 1934 it has not been possible to do justice to all aspects of the Indian struggle. On analysing, we find several streams of activity. There is the main stream—the political movement, which is under the leadership of the Indian National Congress. Then there is a subsidiary stream—the workers' movement under the leadership of the All-India Trade Union Congress. There is also an independent movement of the peasantry in the different provinces, which has not yet emerged as a centralised all-India movement. Besides other subsidiary movements like the women's movement, the youth movement and the students' movement, there is one other movement quite independent of the Congress, which has been a serious problem to the Government. This is the revolutionary movement. This movement has had its ramifications all over India, more or less, but one could say that on the whole it has found greater support in Upper India and that comparatively speaking, Bengal is the stronghold of this movement. Up till now no serious attempt has ever been made to understand the psychology behind the movement. An important officer of the Government, Lieut.-Col. Berkeley-Hill, I.M.S., a well-known psychiatrist, who has been for years in charge of a mental hospital in India, once suggested to the Government that they should attempt a systematic psychological study of the problem, but his advice was not taken. In the present circumstances of the country it is extremely risky for an honest Indian to volunteer an explanation. He would at once be accused of sympathy with the movement and would be liable to be put in prison without trial. Therefore, when Indians do attempt to throw light on this problem they usually make silly statements with the sole object of pleasing the rulers. For instance, it is customary for people to say that the revolutionary movement is the result of